CLASS 9 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 01

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one passage with 12 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 8 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.
6. Answers must be written in the answer book in the order of the questions.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 12 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 12

A good night's sleep is often treated as a luxury, yet it is closer to a basic need. During sleep the body repairs its tissues, the brain sorts what it has learned during the day, and the mind prepares itself for fresh thoughts. A student who sleeps for six hours or less may feel that she has gained extra time, but the truth is that she has borrowed it from tomorrow. Memory weakens, tempers shorten and small tasks begin to feel heavy.

Doctors suggest that teenagers need between eight and ten hours of sleep. The difficulty is that bright screens in the evening trick the brain into believing that it is still daytime. A phone held close to the face at eleven at night can delay sleep by an hour or more. Many young people therefore lie awake with tired eyes and a restless mind.

Sleep also shapes the way we feel about other people. A tired student is quick to take offence, slow to forgive and unwilling to listen. Teachers often notice that a class which has slept well works in an atmosphere of patience, while a sleepless class turns small disagreements into quarrels. Athletes know this too; coaches of young players insist on rest before a match as firmly as they insist on practice.

Parents can help by setting an example. A home in which the television glows until midnight cannot expect a child to sleep at nine. Families that agree on a quiet hour, keep phones outside the bedroom and eat dinner together find that the whole house sleeps better. Rest, in the end, is not the opposite of work; it is the part of work that is done silently in the dark.

It is worth remembering that sleep cannot be saved up like pocket money. Sitting up all week and sleeping all Sunday does not repay the debt, because the brain needs its rest in regular instalments. Students preparing for examinations are often tempted to study through the night, yet those who revise in the evening and sleep well usually recall far more in the examination hall. A rested mind finds the answer quickly; a tired one searches in the dark for a word it knew yesterday. The best preparation, therefore, includes the pillow.

The remedy is a gentle routine. Going to bed at the same hour each night, switching off screens half an hour before sleeping, and reading a few pages of a printed book are small habits that train the body to relax. Light dinners and a short walk in the evening help as well. None of these steps costs money, yet together they can change how a person feels in the morning.

(i) According to the passage, sleep is closer to: 1

(a) a reward **(b)** a basic need **(c)** a punishment **(d)** a luxury

(ii) A student who sleeps for six hours or less has actually: 1

(a) improved memory **(b)** borrowed time from tomorrow

(c) saved energy **(d)** gained extra time

(iii) The recommended sleep for teenagers is: 1

(a) four to six hours **(b)** five hours

(c) eight to ten hours **(d)** ten to twelve hours

(iv) Evening screens affect sleep because they: 1

(a) produce loud noise **(b)** trick the brain into thinking it is daytime

(c) make people hungry **(d)** make the room warm

(v) Which habit is NOT suggested in the passage? 1

(a) Switching off screens early **(b)** Reading a printed book

(c) Fixed bedtime **(d)** Drinking coffee before bed

(vi) Name two things that happen in the body during sleep. 1

(vii) What can a phone at eleven at night do? 1

(viii) What is the 'gentle routine' the writer recommends? Mention one part. 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage which means 'unable to rest'. 1

(x) Why does the writer say these steps are easy to follow? 1

(xi) According to the added paragraphs, a class that has slept well works in an atmosphere of: 1

(a) competition **(b)** patience **(c)** fear **(d)** noise

(xii) How can parents help children sleep better? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage, 200–250 words) — 8 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 8

The Eco Club of Mastermind Public School decided to reduce the paper used in the school office. In September it counted the sheets of paper used by each section and then began a campaign called 'Print Less, Save More'. Teachers were asked to send circulars through the school app and to use both sides of a sheet for rough work. Notices on the board were kept short and shared with several classes at once.

Section	Sheets used in September	Sheets used in October
Office	2400	1500
Examination branch	3000	2700
Library	600	400
Classrooms	1800	1500

At the end of October, the Principal congratulated the club. She noted that the Office had made the largest saving, while the Examination branch, which must print question papers, had saved the least in number. She also announced that the money saved would be used to buy saplings for the school garden, and that the campaign would continue for the whole session. Students were invited to suggest further ideas to the club's suggestion box near the main gate.

The club has also decided to publish a monthly 'paper meter' on the notice board, showing how many sheets each section used, so that everyone can see the progress and feel responsible for it.

(i) The campaign launched by the Eco Club was called: 1

(a) Print Less, Save More **(b)** Paper Free School

(c) Save a Tree **(d)** Green Office

(ii) Which section made the largest saving in sheets? 1

(a) Library **(b)** Classrooms

(c) Examination branch **(d)** Office

(iii) The money saved will be used to buy: 1

(a) notebooks **(b)** printers

(c) saplings for the garden **(d)** new computers

(iv) Teachers were asked to send circulars through the: 1

(a) post **(b)** notice board only

(c) students **(d)** school app

(v) How many sheets did the Library save? 1

(vi) Why did the Examination branch save the least? 1

(vii) Name one way, mentioned in the text, of using less paper. 1

(viii) Where can students put suggestions for the club? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

MASTERMIND